

Weldoo - Effort Estimate

Functional development effort estimate for converting the current prototype into a working responsive web app. The estimate assumes one developer using Codex extensively for implementation, refactoring, testing support, and documentation.

Executive Summary

Scope	Target Estimate	Planning Number
Phase 1 - Strong MVP	350-550 hours	500 hours
Phase 2 - Product Evolution	400-810 hours	600 hours
Combined Phase 1 + Phase 2	750-1,360 hours	1,100 hours

The recommended planning number for Phase 1 is 500 hours. This includes product decisions, implementation, AI-assisted development, human validation, QA, integration, and launch preparation.

Phase 1 Scope

Phase 1 is the strong MVP. It focuses on validating the core Weldoo value proposition with real users.

- Authentication and onboarding by user type: professional/welder, company, training provider.
- Welding-specific editable profiles with skills, processes, materials, positions, certifications, availability, and work preferences.
- Professional feed with posts, comments, likes, saved posts, image upload, and basic reporting.
- Professional network and directory with search, filters, public profiles, and connections or follows.
- Jobs board with job listings, search, filters, saved jobs, company posting, and simple applications.
- Academy, courses, and events with listing, detail pages, filters, saved items, and interest registration.
- Contact requests or simple 1:1 messaging.
- Basic internal notifications.
- Admin and moderation panel.
- Responsive web app experience for desktop, tablet, and mobile.

Phase 1 Module Estimate

Module	Estimate
Product cleanup / specification	12-24h
Technical setup, architecture, and deployment	30-50h
Prototype conversion into responsive app	50-90h
Auth and onboarding	25-45h
Profiles	45-75h
Feed	55-90h
Network / directory	35-60h
Jobs	40-70h
Academy/events	35-60h
Contact request / simple messaging	30-60h
Admin/moderation	40-70h
QA, mobile polish, and launch fixes	40-70h

Human vs AI Effort - Phase 1

The 500-hour planning number should be treated as total project effort. Codex can accelerate implementation, but the developer still needs to guide, review, test, integrate, and make product decisions.

Work Type	Approx. Hours	Share
AI-assisted implementation	280-330h equivalent	56-66%
Human validation and technical review	120-160h	24-32%
Product decisions, QA, integration, launch preparation	50-90h	10-18%

Practical recommendation: plan for at least one third of the total effort to be human-led validation, review, QA, and decision-making. Codex can write a lot of code, but it should not replace engineering judgement.

Phase 2 Scope

Phase 2 includes functionality intentionally excluded from the first MVP. These modules add product maturity but also increase technical risk and implementation cost.

- Payments: paid courses, subscriptions, featured job postings, company plans, checkout, and invoicing.
- Integrated live video: embedded webinar rooms, permissions, attendance, and session state.
- Complex recommendations: jobs, courses, contacts, and personalised feed ranking.
- Certification verification: uploads, admin review, verified badges, and expiry fields.
- Advanced chat: real-time messages, read states, attachments, blocking, and richer messaging workflows.
- Advanced notifications: email flows, preferences, digests, and real-time updates.

Native iOS and Android apps are not part of the planned scope. Weldoo is planned as a responsive web app.

Phase 2 Module Estimate

Module	Estimate
Payments: plans, checkout, invoicing, paid courses or featured jobs	40-80h
Integrated live video: embedded room, permissions, session state, attendance	70-140h
Complex recommendations: jobs, courses, contacts, feed ranking	60-130h
Certification verification: uploads, admin review, verified badges, expiry fields	60-120h
Advanced chat: real-time messages, read states, attachments, blocking	70-140h
Advanced notifications: email flows, preferences, digests, real-time updates	50-110h
Phase 2 QA, migration, polish, and production hardening	50-90h

Human vs AI Effort - Phase 2

Work Type	Approx. Hours	Share
AI-assisted implementation	300-380h equivalent	50-63%
Human validation and technical review	160-210h	27-35%
Product decisions, QA, security, integration	70-120h	12-20%

Phase 2 requires more human validation because it includes payments, real-time features, verification workflows, and more complex infrastructure.

Codex Subscription and Credits

A 100 EUR/month Codex-oriented subscription is likely enough to start and probably enough for Phase 1 if development happens over 3-4 months with normal usage. It may be insufficient if the work is compressed into 1-2 months or if many agents, fast mode, or large-context tasks are used heavily.

Phase	Suggested AI Budget
Phase 1	300-500 EUR subscription cost + 100-300 EUR optional extra credits
Phase 2	400-800 EUR+ depending on intensity and timeline
Recommendation	Start with 100 EUR/month, measure usage after Sprint 0 and Sprint 1, then recalibrate.

Recommended Execution Plan

Sprint	Focus
Sprint 0	Stack choice, data model, repo setup, auth/database/deployment, prototype conversion start.
Sprint 1	Auth, onboarding, public and editable profiles, welding-specific profile data.
Sprint 2	Feed, posts, comments, likes, saved posts, reports.
Sprint 3	Professional directory, search, filters, connection/follow model.
Sprint 4	Jobs listing, detail, company posting, simple application, saved jobs.
Sprint 5	Academy/events listing, detail, filters, interest registration, saved courses/events.
Sprint 6	Contact requests/simple messaging, admin, moderation, responsive QA, private beta prep.

Planning Recommendation

Use 500 hours as the planning number for Phase 1 and 600 hours for Phase 2. For budgeting, treat the AI subscription as an accelerator rather than a replacement for human effort. The limiting factor will usually be product clarity, validation, QA, and integration, not raw code generation.